Research Laboratory (DMRL) in Hyderabad, succeeded Prof. Ramanna. Dr Arunachalam was known for his confidence, and he cared little for the intricacies and nuances of the scientific bureaucracy. Meanwhile, I understand that the Defence Minister at that time, R Venkataraman discussed the matter of my taking over the missile laboratory with Prof. Dhawan. Prof. Dhawan also seemed to be waiting for a decisive step at the highest level in the Defence Ministry. Overcoming the niggling doubts that had caused delays over the past year, the decision to appoint me Director, DRDL was final y taken in February, 1982.

Prof. Dhawan used to visit my room in the ISRO headquarters and spend many hours in evolving space launch vehicle projects. It was a great privilege to work with such a great scientist. Before I left ISRO, Prof. Dhawan asked me to give a talk on the Space Programme Profile in India by the year 2000. Almost the entire ISRO management and staff attended my talk, which was by way of a farewel meeting.

I had met Dr VS Arunachalam in 1976, when I visited DMRL in connection with the aluminium al oy investment